

The A to Z of Karma by AiR

TOPIC: KARMA & ACTION

Q: What is the simple definition of Karma according to the author?

A: What is Karma? Karma means action. It is doing. It is not just thinking. A thought is not Karma and neither is a feeling, Karma. When a thought becomes a feeling that leads to an action, that action becomes Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 1: Karma Means Action, Page 8

Q: How do human actions differ from animal actions in the context of Karma?

A: Every living being acts but it is only a human being who is capable of actions with discrimination. Animals, for instance, act out of instinct or some kind of a trigger but a human being not only thinks, he processes his thoughts and then, chooses his actions. These actions may be good or bad. Our life is full of actions. Nobody can escape from action.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 1: Karma Means Action, Page 8

Q: Is it possible for a human being to live without performing any action?

A: Can a man live without any action? Can he sleep for one year without getting out of bed? No, he can't! He has to eat, he has to cook or talk to somebody to give him food. Otherwise, he will be dead. Therefore, we cannot escape from action or Karma. Why is it so important to go so deep into the subject of Karma? It is because Karma or action doesn't stop at action alone. Every action has a reaction. Every act of ours is recorded and good or bad, we will be rewarded or punished for every deed, accordingly.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 1: Karma Means Action, Page 9

Q: Do animals and insects accumulate Karma when they perform actions?

A: Does every animal and insect also have Karma? No! Every animal and insect perform actions but their actions are not Karma. Therefore, Karma is not just action. Karma is the action of a human being. The action of a dog is not its Karma nor is a mosquito that bites us, creating Karma for itself. Only we, human beings, accumulate Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 1: Karma Means Action, Page 9

Q: Why is it that inanimate objects or machines do not create Karma even if they cause harm?

A: We would laugh if somebody asked us, 'Does a car have Karma?' Why? Because we know that a car is just a machine. It may kill somebody on the road but it has no Karma. Similarly, a gun may shoot somebody and a knife may stab somebody but these are just instruments of action. We, who do the action, are creating Karma. Therefore, it is only human beings whose actions are Karma, not the inanimate world and not the other living organisms.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 1: Karma Means Action, Page 9

Q: Does the Law of Karma apply to individuals who are mentally challenged?

A: People wonder, 'So, what about those who are mentally challenged or who have no intellect to discriminate?' They are not covered under the domain of Karma. Their actions do not create Karma. They are only experiencing their past Karma as they live and suffer, just like animals and other creatures do.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 1: Karma Means Action, Page 10

Q: What changes in a person's life when they truly realize the importance of Karma?

A: The day we realize the importance of Karma, we will take charge of our actions. We will take the responsibility of our life. We will not just do but also choose every action, consciously and intelligently. This book can transform your life. It can change the way you act and live. It will not only reveal the truth of Karma or action but will show you the way to be liberated from all suffering on earth and from rebirth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 1: Karma Means Action, Page 10

Q: Are the actions of young children recorded by the Law of Karma?

A: As long as man is alive, he must act. When we are kids, we are innocent and our actions, although Karma, are not recorded by the Law of Karma. This is because we have not developed a mature mind and intellect to discriminate and act. But once we grow up, every action, good or bad is recorded by Karma, the Law.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 4: Can Man Live Without Action?, Page 20

Q: Since action is unavoidable, what is the best strategy for a human being to follow?

A: Because man cannot escape from action, he tries to perform good action. He tries to live as a kind and compassionate being. Not only does he try to do as many good deeds as he can, to as many people as he can and as often as he can but he also stops himself from doing bad things or sins. Man is conscious that his actions or his deeds will become seeds of his destiny.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 4: Can Man Live Without Action?, Page 21

Q: Can our current actions affect the negative deeds we have brought from past lives?

A: Through Agami Karma, our current account of actions, we can nullify some of our opening balance, our past Karma that we bring as Prarabdha into this world. Suppose, I am carrying hundreds of negative Karma as my Karmic debt. By doing good Karma in my present life, I can create positive Agami Karma that can nullify or redeem my Prarabdha Karma or the opening balance.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 8: Agami Karma, Our Current Account, Page 36

Q: What choice do we have regarding our actions and their subsequent reactions?

A: We have a choice. We can choose our actions. Every action is a Karma. We can choose good Karma or bad Karma but whatever be the action, so will be the reaction. Good or bad, all actions will be recorded and ultimately when the body dies, these Karma will be recorded and we will return in a rebirth, based on our Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 8: Agami Karma, Our Current Account, Page 37

Q: Should we be worried about our negative thoughts in relation to the Law of Karma?

A: Karma is a law of action. So, we don't have to worry about thoughts. Rather, we have to use our intellect and deflect negative thoughts from becoming actions. Once a thought becomes an action, we have to realize that there is no way to escape the reaction.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 16: Overcoming Ignorance And Suffering, Page 68

Q: Are we essentially robots if our lives are governed by our past Karma?

A: Karma or action is like a seed, planted. It will bear fruit. Whatever is happening in our life is not bad luck. It is not the will of a cruel God. It is our own Karma returning to us. We must accept without protest. Are we therefore, machines living a life predestined by Karma? No! We have a free will and an intellect to discriminate and choose. Our past Karma will unfold but our present Karma is in our hands.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 16: Overcoming Ignorance And Suffering, Page 68

Q: How are life and Karma interconnected according to the book's conclusion?

A: Everything in life is Karma. There is no Karma without life, just as there is no life without Karma. Anybody who is alive faces Karma. Our birth is because of Karma. We did not come to earth for nothing. We arrived on the planet because of our past Karma. Once we are born, we have to do Karma. We can neither be free from doing Karma nor can we be free from our past Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 29: Life Is Karma, Page 120

Q: Does every single action we take result in a record in our Karmic account?

A: The Law of Karma is called by this name only because it is a law of action. Therefore, yes, each and every action of ours, good or bad, is recorded and creates Karma or an automatic reaction that will come back to us corresponding to our deeds, good or bad.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 29: Life Is Karma, Page 123

TOPIC: THE LAW OF KARMA (Action & Reaction)

Q: What is the fundamental principle behind the Law of Karma and how does it relate to other laws of the universe?

A: The Law of Karma is based on the principle, 'As you sow, so shall you reap. What you do will come back to you!' It is the Law of Action and Reaction. This law seems to have been created by the Creator of this universe. Just like there is the Law of Gravity that states that everything gets pulled to the centre of the earth due to a force called Gravity, the Law of Karma governs everything unfolding on the planet. There are many Universal Laws. The Law of Cycles ensures that the earth rotates precisely, once in 24 hours, the cycle of seasons and the revolution of the earth around the sun, are all a part of the several Universal Laws that govern our planet.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 2: What Is The Law Of Karma?, Page 12

Q: Does the Law of Karma only apply while we are alive, or does it also influence our birth and death?

A: The Law of Karma is unique. Not only does it apply during our lifetime but it is also responsible for our death, just as it controls our birth. Did you choose how you came to earth? No, it was Karma. Thereafter, everything that is unfolding in our life is unfolding as per Karma, our past actions. Even our death is controlled by Karma. When we die, our Karma doesn't get finished. We carry forward our Karma into a new life. Therefore, we cannot escape Karma even after we die. Until we realize the A to Z of Karma, we will never realize the truth of how it works.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 2: What Is The Law Of Karma?, Page 13

Q: How does the principle of cause and effect apply to our secret actions and different types of deeds?

A: The Law of Karma is based on the principle of cause and effect. Our action becomes the cause and this cause will result in an effect. Good actions will be the cause of a good reaction or a good effect and bad actions will become seeds that will sprout as a bad destiny. Neutral actions will result in neutral reactions and therefore, they are not recorded by Karma. Let us not imagine that any of our actions done behind closed doors can escape the purview of Karma. The Karmic monitor is within each one of us. It is more powerful than any video camera or audio recorder. It will capture every action and will ensure that we redeem the same.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 2: What Is The Law Of Karma?, Page 13

Q: Is the Law of Karma reliable, and why should we trust its perfection?

A: Just like any Universal Law, the Law of Karma is perfect. Have we ever seen the earth suddenly rotate in the opposite direction? Do we doubt that our tables and chairs will suddenly start flying in the sky? The world is governed by perfect Universal Laws and one

such law is the Law of Karma. Therefore, we must not make any mistake in understanding this law, accepting it and living our life following the principles of the Law of Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 2: What Is The Law Of Karma?, Page 14

Q: Is there anyone supervising the Law of Karma, and can it be transcended?

A: The Law of Karma is automatic, like any other Universal Law. It needs no intervention. It controls our death, our birth and how we will return to earth. Nobody can escape this law but those rare few who understand the A to Z of Karma may be able to transcend Karma and be liberated, not just from the Karma that unfolds on earth but also from rebirth. For this, one needs Enlightenment, and this is not common. 99% of us just live, do our Karma and die. Based on our actions, good or bad, the Law of Karma will either reward us or punish us, respectively.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 3: How Does The Law Of Karma Work?, Page 18

Q: At what point in a person's life does the Law of Karma begin to record their actions?

A: As long as man is alive, he must act. When we are kids, we are innocent and our actions, although Karma, are not recorded by the Law of Karma. This is because we have not developed a mature mind and intellect to discriminate and act. But once we grow up, every action, good or bad is recorded by Karma, the Law.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 4: Can Man Live Without Action?, Page 20

Q: Are the events in our life caused by our current choices or by our past deeds?

A: Everything that is happening in our life is happening because of Karma. Either it is our past Karma, our past actions that are unfolding or it is our present Karma that is the result of our own conscious choices.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 5: Every Action Has A Reaction, Page 24

Q: How does the Law of Karma contradict the traditional belief in luck or astrology?

A: Nothing happens by luck or chance. Somehow the world believes a lot in luck and therefore, the businesses of astrology and palmistry thrive. Don't we look up at the stars and wonder, 'What do the stars have in store for us?' Because we do not understand the simple Law of Karma, we submit ourselves to the horoscopes that tell us that our life is unfolding depending on the date and time of our birth and the position of our stars, thinking them to be true. Everything is unfolding as per Karma and not as per the wish of the stars.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 5: Every Action Has A Reaction, Page 25

Q: Does God personally manage every event on earth, or is there an automatic system in place?

A: Let us know, beyond doubt that just as every seed will sprout, every action will result in a reaction. We don't know when and we don't know for what but some or the other time, our action will be redeemed with a reaction. So also, everything that is happening is nothing but a redemption of a past action. The universe is an organized place and everything is governed by the Universal Laws. Nothing in this world happens as random acts nor does a distant God in the sky micromanage whatever unfolds on earth. Everything that is happening is a reaction to an action.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 5: Every Action Has A Reaction, Page 26

Q: If every action has a reaction, does that mean we have no choice but to follow a predestined path?

A: Karma or action is like a seed, planted. It will bear fruit. Whatever is happening in our life is not bad luck. It is not the will of a cruel God. It is our own Karma returning to us. We must accept without protest. Are we therefore, machines living a life predestined by Karma? No! We have a free will and an intellect to discriminate and choose. Our past Karma will unfold but our present Karma is in our hands. When all Karmic concepts are clear, it is easy to transcend Karma and achieve our ultimate goal.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 16: Overcoming Ignorance And Suffering, Page 68

Q: Is the Law of Karma designed primarily to punish people for their past mistakes?

A: The Law of Karma is mistakenly thought of as a draconian law. Many shudder when they realize that they have to suffer for their sins, not just of this lifetime but of the several lives that they may have lived earlier. Somehow, they feel hopeless and helpless and consider the Law of Karma to be a law that wants to punish them. Little do we realize that Karma is not punitive. It is reformatory. The purpose of Karma is not just to punish us, rather, to refine and reform us.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 17: Karma Is Not Punitive, It Is Reformatory, Page 72

Q: How does the Law of Karma provide justice, and can this system ever be corrupted?

A: Of course, Karma will punish us for the sins that we have committed. For every bad deed that we do, we have to face an equally bad situation or circumstance. We can't escape our sins. But then, what about our good deeds? Even these deeds become seeds for which, we are rewarded. Therefore, isn't Karma a fair law? It is based on the principle, 'As you sow, so shall you reap.' If we do not want to suffer, why do we sin? If we want to win, we can choose to do good deeds. The Law of Karma is a Universal Law. It provides justice on earth, just like the several courts of law. While the judiciary in the world is expected to be honest but may

sometimes, be corrupt, the Law of Karma can never be corrupted. It is a Divine law, a law that is created by SIP, the Supreme Immortal Power.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 17: Karma Is Not Punitive, It Is Reformative, Page 72

Q: Does the Law of Karma consider our intentions or the necessity of an action, such as self-defense?

A: It is said that the Law of Karma works with certain reasonable principles. So, for instance, if there is a snake that's trying to attack you and kill you, you have every right to protect your life - that is your duty. But if a mosquito is about to bite you, you can always avoid it by batting it away, or prevent it by using certain mosquito repellants or by keeping the room clean. When you realize that life is nothing but God, then you don't kill, you don't take life. You avoid killing anything. But in cases where it is unavoidable, then we have to do what our intellect tells us to do. Whether we create negative Karma or not depends on the deed. If our act is an act of cruelty, an act of indifference or an act of murder, definitely we will create negative Karma. On the other hand, if our act is an act of self-defence, an act that is justified, then there is no negative Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 0: FAQ ON KARMA, Page 127

Q: Is absolutely every single action we take recorded by the Law of Karma?

A: The Law of Karma is called by this name only because it is a law of action. Therefore, yes, each and every action of ours, good or bad, is recorded and creates Karma or an automatic reaction that will come back to us corresponding to our deeds, good or bad.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 0: FAQ ON KARMA, Page 123

Q: Does the reaction we receive always exactly match the action we performed?

A: Karma is a law of compensation and redemption. However, nobody truly knows whether our bad deeds will be returned with a mirror reaction by Karma, or we will face a worse or a milder reaction. Karma is a law of the Cosmic Creator, and we have not been given the ability to comprehend how the law exactly works. We can understand the law by inference. We have some indication of how the law works. But we cannot be exactly sure how the law works. However, since it is a law of action and reaction, cause and effect, redemption and compensation, there is no doubt that there would be an eye for an eye in that sense till we are liberated from Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 0: FAQ ON KARMA, Page 126

TOPIC 3: WHY BAD THINGS HAPPEN & SUFFERING

Q: How is it possible that a person who is seemingly good still faces negative circumstances?

A: If something bad is happening to a seemingly good person, it only means that this good person has some Karmic debt, some negative Karma in his account. We need not doubt this

because the Law of Karma is a Law of Action and Reaction. Unless there is an action, there cannot be a reaction. Therefore, what is unfolding in anybody's life is the result of their past action. Such is the Law of Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 3: How Does The Law Of Karma Work?, Page 16

Q: Does God allow bad things to happen to people who haven't done anything wrong?

A: Bad things cannot happen to good people, just as apples cannot grow on mango trees. Such is the Universal Law. The law states, 'As you sow, so shall you reap.' Therefore, if bad things are happening, there is no other option but to believe that bad actions or Karma have been performed.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 6: Why Do Bad Things Happen To Good People?, Page 28

Q: Why does a kind and compassionate person sometimes face extreme misery and misfortune?

A: The fact is that whatever is unfolding, may be a result of past actions or actions done, long ago, which have either been forgotten or the actions of a previous life that were not settled. If bad things are happening, they are because of bad deeds or bad Karma. There is no other possibility.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 6: Why Do Bad Things Happen To Good People?, Page 28

Q: How should one react when they witness or experience something going wrong?

A: The next time you see something going wrong in somebody's life, don't wonder, 'Why?' Just as if you find a possible threat waiting to unfold, don't just hope that it doesn't. What you can do is just do your best. After doing your best, you must learn to accept without protest and surrender the rest to Karma. We have no other choice.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 6: Why Do Bad Things Happen To Good People?, Page 29

Q: What determines the specific circumstances and difficulties we face at the beginning of our lives?

A: Good things and bad things are not happening because people are good or bad. Things happen the way they do because our past Karma is being settled. All our past Karma remains as Karmic debt in our Karmic account. Then, we are born with a bunch of Karma as the opening balance or Prarabdha Karma. This may be good or bad but this must be redeemed. Therefore, this unfolds in our life as our circumstances.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 7: Prarabdha Karma, Our Opening Balance, Page 32

Q: How can the Law of Karma explain why a child might be born with a disability like blindness?

A: Many people wonder, 'Why is some child born blind?' Is it because God is not kind? Of course not! It is due to Karma. Destiny or chance is nothing but Karma and it starts with our opening balance, Prarabdha Karma, in every lifetime. In the end, the closing balance gets carried forward into our warehouse or corpus of Karma called Sanchita Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 7: Prarabdha Karma, Our Opening Balance, Page 33

Q: Is there any positive way to look at the experience of suffering or bad events?

A: So, what must we do, when something bad happens? It may sound strange but we must rejoice because that Karma, which was in our account, is now settled. We have redeemed our Karmic debt. If it was not so, then, we would have that pending in our Karmic account and it could hit at us, anytime. Therefore, those who understand Karma and its three accounts, learn to accept without protest.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 10: The Karma Cycle Goes On And On..., Page 45

Q: How can a child who has done no wrong be born into extreme poverty and suffering?

A: A child could be living in a slum and we may wonder what wrong the child has done to suffer in poverty. It may be a right observation that the child has done no harm but what about the one who has been born as the child? The body is formed in the womb of our mother. The body is just an instrument of Karma. It only appears to suffer, just as it appears to be rewarded. The truth is that the Karma belongs to the Mind and Ego, ME, that is born as this little baby. The suffering maybe experienced by the body but in reality, the one who is suffering is ME.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 11: Who Decided Your Birth?, Page 48

Q: Is God responsible for micromanaging the suffering or fortune of every individual on earth?

A: God is not micromanaging the destiny of 8 billion people. Everything is being controlled by Karma. As we grow, we have the privilege of choosing our actions and these actions get added to our Prarabdha Karma and unfold as our destiny.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 11: Who Decided Your Birth?, Page 49

Q: Does the Law of Karma apply only to humans, or does it explain the suffering of animals as well?

A: When we look at life unfolding from a Karmic perspective, we realize that the whole world is controlled by Karma. Even a dog that is suffering, seems to be the result of Karma. All suffering in this world is Karmic. A tree is bound to the ground but it is alive. Every living

creature has feelings. It seems that every living organism is born to settle the score of past Karma. Through inference, this seems to be the only logic.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 11: Who Decided Your Birth?, Page 49

Q: Is it possible for a person with mostly good Karma to still experience suffering on earth?

A: Even if our Sanchita Karma or our warehouse is full of positive Karma, the moment we come to earth as a body, mind and ego, we have no option but to suffer the pain of the body, misery of the mind and agony of the ego. This is called the Triple Suffering. The only way to be free from misery on earth and from rebirth is to be free from all three accounts of Karma and this, certainly is possible.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 9: Sanchita Karma, Our Corpus Or Warehouse, Page 42

Q: How does realizing our true identity as the Soul help us deal with mental and emotional suffering?

A: More important than physical pain, when we overcome the ignorance that we are not the mind, we become free from toxic thoughts that create fear, worry, stress, anxiety, regret, shame and guilt. The mind and ego, together, often agonize us with anger, hate, revenge and jealousy. When we overcome ignorance and realize that I am not this body, mind and ego, we will be free from all anguish and suffering.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 16: Overcoming Ignorance And Suffering, Page 70

Q: Is the purpose of the Law of Karma simply to punish people for their mistakes?

A: Of course, Karma will punish us for the sins that we have committed. For every bad deed that we do, we have to face an equally bad situation or circumstance. We can't escape our sins. But then, what about our good deeds? Even these deeds become seeds for which, we are rewarded. Therefore, isn't Karma a fair law? It is based on the principle, 'As you sow, so shall you reap.'

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 17: Karma Is Not Punitive, It Is Reformative, Page 72

Q: Why is it believed that every human being is destined to suffer to some degree in this life?

A: Every human being who lives has the goal of Mukti, the goal of realizing that we are not the body, mind and ego but the Soul. Every human being wants to be liberated from suffering but unfortunately whoever is born must suffer the triple suffering of the body, mind and ego despite their past Karma. Mukti liberates us from all suffering on earth and from rebirth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 18: Mukti, Freedom From Karma, Page 78

Q: How should our understanding of Karma change our attitude toward tragedies and accidents?

A: Sometimes, we face a tragedy, an accident and we curse the one we think has caused it. We even attribute the misery to God. When we realize the truth that everything is controlled by Karma, our own past actions, then, we will stop cursing, just as we will stop nursing and rehearsing what has happened. We will accept it as a reward or punishment for our own past deeds.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 26: Karma, Death And Rebirth, Page 109

TOPIC 4: TYPES OF KARMA (Prarabdha, Agami, Sanchita)

Q: What are the three distinct accounts that make up our Karma?

A: Karma has 3 accounts. The first is Prarabdha Karma. It is the opening balance of our Karmic Account. The second is Agami Karma or the current account that accumulates the actions done in the present birth. The third account is Sanchita Karma, which is the corpus or the warehouse of our Karma. Let us first understand Prarabdha Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 7: Prarabdha Karma, Our Opening Balance, Page 32

Q: What is the significance of Prarabdha Karma in relation to our birth?

A: Our past Karma doesn't disappear into nothingness. It becomes the seed that is planted for our future. Nothing happens by chance nor is there some distant God in a far-away heaven deciding our birth. It is our Prarabdha Karma or our opening balance that brings us to earth in a birth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 7: Prarabdha Karma, Our Opening Balance, Page 32

Q: How does the redemption of Prarabdha Karma affect an individual's life?

A: As our Prarabdha Karma, the opening balance of Karma that we start our life with gets redeemed, it will not be repeated. For instance, I may have a hundred positive and a hundred negative Karma in my opening balance. I have to settle the score. I have no option but to face this Karma which I have carried into the world. Yes, I can choose to do good Karma and settle some of this but if I don't, then the opening balance will continue throughout my life till the score is settled.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 7: Prarabdha Karma, Our Opening Balance, Page 32

Q: How does Agami Karma differ from Prarabdha Karma in terms of personal control?

A: The second account of Karma is called Agami Karma or the current account. Everything that we are doing in life, our present actions are recorded in this account of Karma. Whatever

is unfolding as our life is because of Prarabdha Karma or the opening balance, over which we have no control but we have complete control on our present Karma, the Agami or the current account of Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 8: Agami Karma, Our Current Account, Page 36

Q: How do the opening balance and current account of Karma interact within our life?

A: In fact, our Prarabdha and Agami Karma, the opening balance and current account, merge to become one account, just like in a bank. Then, everything that unfolds as life is due to the unsettled Karma that we brought to earth, as well as all the Karma that we have done in the present birth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 8: Agami Karma, Our Current Account, Page 36

Q: Is it possible to use our present actions to offset the negative Karma we were born with?

A: Through Agami Karma, our current account of actions, we can nullify some of our opening balance, our past Karma that we bring as Prarabdha into this world. Suppose, I am carrying hundreds of negative Karma as my Karmic debt. By doing good Karma in my present life, I can create positive Agami Karma that can nullify or redeem my Prarabdha Karma or the opening balance.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 8: Agami Karma, Our Current Account, Page 36

Q: Why is Agami Karma considered the most important of the three types?

A: Therefore, Agami Karma, our present Karma or the current account is the most important Karma of all. This Karma is an opportunity in our hands. We cannot change our past Karma that we bring as our opening balance but we have been given an opportunity to choose our present Karma and by doing so, create a destiny of our choice.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 8: Agami Karma, Our Current Account, Page 37

Q: What is Sanchita Karma and how is it formed at the time of death?

A: It is known as Sanchita Karma. It is the account that is our warehouse or corpus, where we carry forward all the unsettled Karma from each life. When a man dies, he has some Karma that is unsettled. It may be good or bad. He started with an opening balance and he had a current account but everything is not settled in the moment of death. Death is sudden and there is always unsettled Karma that gets carried forward into our corpus or warehouse. This corpus is called our Sanchita Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 9: Sanchita Karma, Our Corpus Or Warehouse, Page 40

Q: How does Sanchita Karma act as the source for future lifetimes?

A: Sanchita Karma is the Karma that we carry forward, life after life. From this, a part is used as Prarabdha Karma or the opening balance for one life. As long as there is Sanchita Karma, we have no option but to return to earth in a rebirth. Only the one who is liberated from all Karma can escape this cycle of rebirth and not return to earth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 9: Sanchita Karma, Our Corpus Or Warehouse, Page 40

Q: What distinguishes human Karma from the actions of other living creatures regarding Sanchita Karma?

A: Every living creature is born with a Prarabdha Karma which comes from their Sanchita Karma. Every living creature carries a warehouse. Then they are born only to consume some of their Karma. Since they do not create new Karma, they live, consume their Karma and die. They need to continue doing this until they are born as a human being. It is only a human being who can create new Karma and even wipe out Sanchita Karma or the cumulative Karma of all lifetimes.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 9: Sanchita Karma, Our Corpus Or Warehouse, Page 40

Q: What is the way to potentially rid oneself of the entire warehouse of Sanchita Karma?

A: When we realize the truth that Sanchita Karma doesn't actually belong to us, then in one moment we can be liberated from all Karma and from this continuous cycle of death and rebirth. But if we don't realize the truth about Karma, about who does Karma and who carries it forward, we will continue to suffer.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 9: Sanchita Karma, Our Corpus Or Warehouse, Page 42

Q: How can the relationship between Prarabdha Karma and Free Will be explained using a car analogy?

A: While we are born with an opening balance of Karma, we are also given a Free Will to choose. Only human beings are blessed with an intellect to discriminate. Let me make you understand this, in simple terms. Suppose, you are driving a car. The car is in your control and you can go fast or slow, turn left or right, go ahead or reverse. This is your free will or your present Karma. This is not your Prarabdha Karma or the opening balance. However, you can't change the road. The road is already laid. This is like your past Karma, which cannot be changed.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 7: Prarabdha Karma, Our Opening Balance, Page 34

Q: What happens to Agami Karma that remains unresolved at the end of a lifetime?

A: The unsettled Karma of Agami, our current account that merges with Prarabdha, our opening balance is tabulated and the Karma that is not redeemed in this lifetime will be added into our corpus or warehouse, Sanchita Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 8: Agami Karma, Our Current Account, Page 38

Q: What role does Agami Karma play in the path to eventual Enlightenment and freedom from Sanchita Karma?

A: If we attain Enlightenment, then not only will we be free from all Karma on earth, our Agami or present Karma and Prarabdha or opening balance, but we will also be free from Sanchita Karma, the corpus or warehouse of cumulative Karma. Once we are free from all Karma, we don't have to return to earth in a rebirth. But this depends on our present Karma or the Agami Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 8: Agami Karma, Our Current Account, Page 37

Q: What is the status of the three Karma accounts for a person who has achieved Mukti?

A: Not only are we free from Agami Karma, the current account or present Karma but we are also free from Prarabdha Karma, the opening balance and the accumulated corpus account, Sanchita Karma. We are Mukti. We are free. We are liberated. When we were born, our birth was because of our Prarabdha Karma. It was the opening balance that we started this life with, as the body, mind and ego. However, on realizing that we are not the body, mind and ego, even our Prarabdha Karma or opening balance is wiped out.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 18: Mukti, Freedom From Karma, Page 77

TOPIC 5: THE KARMA CYCLE, BIRTH & REBIRTH

Q: Will the process of Karma eventually come to an end for a person after they die?

A: Karma is a cycle. It will go on and on. Only the body dies but the Mind and Ego, ME, will carry Karma and be reborn. It doesn't matter whether it is good Karma or bad Karma. As long as there is an action, there will be a reaction. As long as there is cause, the effect must come. Every act, as we understand, becomes a seed and so every deed will bear fruit.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 10: The Karma Cycle Goes On And On..., Page 44

Q: What happens to the actions that have not yet been repaid by the time a person passes away?

A: Whatever Karma is redeemed in life, is settled. Whatever Karma remains unsettled in this life, will be carried forward and return to earth in a rebirth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 10: The Karma Cycle Goes On And On..., Page 45

Q: How is a person's specific birth and family background determined?

A: Did you decide your birth? Did you decide how you came to earth? Did you decide your parents, your siblings, your gender and your nationality? No, you did not decide or choose any of these. It was all decided by Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 11: Who Decided Your Birth?, Page 48

Q: If a child is born with a disability, is it considered an act of a cruel God?

A: If we are born blind, it is not because God is unkind. It is because of Karma. We don't realize the simple truth that every action of ours is recorded by the Law of Action and Reaction. The action must be settled. It must be redeemed.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 11: Who Decided Your Birth?, Page 48

Q: Since a newborn baby has not yet acted, who is actually responsible for the Karma they were born with?

A: The truth is that the Karma belongs to the Mind and Ego, ME, that is born as this little baby. The suffering maybe experienced by the body but in reality, the one who is suffering is ME.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 11: Who Decided Your Birth?, Page 49

Q: At what point in the biological process does a new Karmic journey begin on earth?

A: Who starts the Karmic journey? There is no body. It is just the Mind and Ego, ME, that is conceived in the first cell of our existence, the zygote. How does this happen? This happens when the Soul, the Spark Of Unique Life, gives life to the Mind and Ego, ME, to start a new journey on earth. Why does this new journey start? It is because the ME has unsettled Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 12: Does Karma Belong To The Body?, Page 52

Q: Why does the cycle of rebirth continue even though the physical body has died?

A: In the moment of death, the body returns to dust and Karma that is unsettled, good or bad, is the cause for us to be reborn. Even though we read this many, many times but our mind will confuse us and stop us from realizing the truth because if we realize the truth, our mind will cease to exist. Therefore, along with the Ego, our Mind becomes ME and it drives action and creates Karma. The ME never dies. It carries Karma into another birth and this cycle goes on.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 12: Does Karma Belong To The Body?, Page 54

Q: Is it possible to escape the need for a new birth if we only have good Karma left?

A: To understand the A to Z of Karma, we must understand that Karma doesn't end in the moment of death. The body dies but ME, the Mind and Ego, returns to earth in a rebirth based on Karma. It may be good or bad Karma. That hardly matters. As long as there is pending unsettled Karma in our Karmic account, we have to return to earth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 14: How Is Karma Carried Forward?, Page 60

Q: How can we understand the invisible transfer of Karma from one life to the next?

A: The universe continues to exist only because Karma is carried forward at death. If this was not to happen, then, as people die, all living creatures would be wiped out from the face of the earth. The doctrine of Karma, the Law of Action and Reaction, does not end at the moment of death. We cannot prove it but we can see the result happen. Just like we cannot see videos and pictures being transferred from one mobile to another but we can access those images in a new mobile, similarly, a new-born child is full of past Karma and there is no other possibility than to infer that this is the carried forward Karma from a previous life.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 14: How Is Karma Carried Forward?, Page 61

Q: Where do heaven and hell actually exist according to the laws of Karma?

A: Heaven and hell are not some distant locations far away amongst the stars! They are experienced here on earth, when we take a rebirth as our Karma is carried forward from one body that dies, to a single-celled zygote that multiplies to eventually become a new body, which will face the Karma that is carried forward, life after life.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 14: How Is Karma Carried Forward?, Page 62

Q: What is the relationship between the actions we perform now and our future birth?

A: Birth, Karma and death are cyclic. The cycle goes on and on, till we are liberated but we must understand, how we are born and how this will go on, if we are not liberated from Karma. We understand that we all have to perform actions once we are born but little do we realize that these are the actions that decide our birth. Somebody is born in the house of a carpenter and somebody else, in a palace. We so conveniently call it luck or fate.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 26: Karma, Death And Rebirth, Page 108

Q: Is the time of our death purely pre-destined by the past, or does present action matter?

A: It is Karma. Not just the past Karma of a previous life, but even the present Karma of this life, together are responsible for our present destiny, our death and our rebirth.

Unfortunately, Karma has kept our past life history as a mystery. That is why we don't know who we were in our previous lives, but Karma knows.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 26: Karma, Death And Rebirth, Page 109

Q: How does Karma regulate the full span of human existence from birth to death?

A: Everything and absolutely everything that is happening is this cycle of action and reaction. Birth is a reaction. Karma is an action. Death is another reaction. Therefore, all our actions, all our Karma are the cause of both our birth and death. Our Karma decides how long we will have breath. Then, it is Karma that will decide whether we will return to earth and what will be our next birth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 26: Karma, Death And Rebirth, Page 109

Q: How does a person finally break the cycle of returning to earth after death?

A: The body will die but the Mind and Ego, ME, carries Karma, birth after birth, as it returns to earth. So, are we the mind and ego? If only we realize that we are not the mind, it is something that we cannot find, it is just a bundle of thoughts and further, if we realize that we are not the ego that keeps saying 'I', 'me' and 'mine', this ego is a false identity, then, we transcend ME, that owns Karma and we go beyond the three accounts of Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 27: Transcending Karma, Page 113

Q: Can life exist without the governance of Karma?

A: Coming to the planet and departing from existence are both under the control of Karma. Therefore, if you remove Karma, there will be no life itself. Our goal is to be free from all Karma. We must not imagine that doing good Karma will take us to heaven, where we will be rewarded. This is the biggest lie.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 29: Life Is Karma, Page 121

TOPIC 6: FREEDOM FROM KARMA (Mukti)

Q: What happens to our Karmic accounts once we achieve the state of Mukti?

A: When we are enlightened with the truth and when there is the Realization that we are not the body, mind and ego, we attain Mukti. What does this mean? It means that we are free from all Karma. Even though we are performing actions, we are not creating any fresh Karma because we have realized that we are not the body, mind and ego. We live as a Divine instrument and thus, none of the Karma done by us is recorded in our Karmic account. In fact, we don't even have a Karmic account anymore because we have realized our true identity. We are neither this body that acts nor the mind and ego that has the three accounts of Karma in its name. Not only are we free from Agami Karma, the current account or present Karma but we are also free from Prarabdha Karma, the opening balance and the accumulated corpus account, Sanchita Karma. We are Mukti. We are free. We are liberated.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 18: Mukti, Freedom From Karma, Page 77

Q: What is a Jivanmukta and what happens to them at the time of death?

A: A person who attains Mukti is now free from all Karma. He is neither creating fresh Karma nor does have to redeem any past Karma. Such a person lives as a Jivanmukta, one who is liberated while alive. In the moment of death when the physical body dies and returns to dust, a Jivanmukta does not return to earth in a rebirth. A Jivanmukta has no Karma to settle. He attains Moksha. He is united with the Divine once he is liberated in the moment of the death of the physical body.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 18: Mukti, Freedom From Karma, Page 78

Q: Why does the false identity of 'Mind and Ego' prevent us from being free from Karma?

A: So long as ME, the Mind and Ego, makes us believe that we are the mind and ego, we have no option but to return to earth in a rebirth carrying our Karma. But the question is, 'Are we the Mind and Ego, ME?' If we go in search of the mind, where is the mind? We cannot find! The ego that keeps saying 'I', 'me' and 'mine', is a false identity. But as long as we believe that we are ME, we cannot be free from Karma. When a body dies, the ME carries all unsettled Karma and returns to earth in a rebirth. Then, how can we ever be free from Karma?

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 15: Can We Be Free From Karma?, Page 64

Q: If we cannot stop acting while alive, how can we achieve freedom in action?

A: As long as we think that we are this body, we will continue to accumulate Karma. Every 'body' has to act. As long as we are alive, there is no freedom from action. But there can be freedom in action. We need to realize that we are not this body. We are just the Divine instrument. In reality, we are the Soul and the Soul has no Karma. Then we can transcend Karma.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 15: Can We Be Free From Karma?, Page 64

Q: Is doing good Karma enough to attain Moksha?

A: Gokul was confused. He asked his Master, 'Are you telling me that doing good Karma is bad?' 'No', replied the Guru, 'We must do good Karma when it comes to choosing between doing good or bad. Serving others is good but our goal is to do it like a Karma Yogi. We must do it with the attitude that I am not the body, mind and ego. We must not expect any fruits or results from our actions or Karma. We must realize that we are the Divine Soul and not ME, the Mind and Ego. Only then, can we be free from Karma.'

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 15: *Can We Be Free From Karma?*, Page 65

Q: What happens to the vast warehouse of past Sanchita Karma at the moment of Realization?

A: What about Sanchita Karma, the warehouse or the corpus of Karma that is carried forward life after life by the Mind and Ego, ME? When there is no mind and ego, when we have realized that we are the Divine Soul, where is the scope for Sanchita Karma to exist? All our past Karma, all our Karma that we carried forward through several past lives gets wiped out in that moment of Mukti, in the moment of Realization of the truth. So, what next?

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 18: *Mukti, Freedom From Karma*, Page 77

Q: How can the action of realizing the truth lead to freedom from the material world?

A: The action of realizing the truth about Karma will reveal to us, a way to be free from Karma, free from suffering and free from rebirth on earth. So, instead of letting our Karma tie us to this material world, we must realize who is actually doing this Karma, why is Karma being done and ultimately, find a way to transcend Karma.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 4: *Can Man Live Without Action?*, Page 22

Q: What is the ultimate goal of human life regarding suffering and rebirth?

A: Every human being who lives has the goal of Mukti, the goal of realizing that we are not the body, mind and ego but the Soul. Every human being wants to be liberated from suffering but unfortunately whoever is born must suffer the triple suffering of the body, mind and ego despite their past Karma. Mukti liberates us from all suffering on earth and from rebirth. This is our ultimate goal, to realize that we are not the body, mind and ego but the Divine Soul.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 18: *Mukti, Freedom From Karma*, Page 78

Q: How can the realization of our true identity liberate us from being the 'doer' of actions?

A: We can attain that state of Mukti, being liberated from Karma through what we call as Realization. When we realize that Karma is performed by the body and we are not the body, so, we are not doing the Karma. Who is directing the body to act? It is the ME, the Mind and Ego. But we are neither the mind, nor the ego. The mind and ego are subtle in their existence. They seem to exist but in reality, they are an illusion. They are a product of our ignorance. Because we do not realize that we are neither the body nor the mind and ego, we create Karma and suffer on earth, as well as, return in a rebirth.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 18: *Mukti, Freedom From Karma*, Page 76

Q: Why is understanding the ownership of Karma crucial for stopping the cycle of rebirth?

A: When we realize the truth that Sanchita Karma doesn't actually belong to us, then in one moment we can be liberated from all Karma and from this continuous cycle of death and rebirth. But if we don't realize the truth about Karma, about who does Karma and who carries it forward, we will continue to suffer. Even if our Sanchita Karma or our warehouse is full of positive Karma, the moment we come to earth as a body, mind and ego, we have no option but to suffer the pain of the body, misery of the mind and agony of the ego.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 9: Sanchita Karma, Our Corpus Or Warehouse, Page 42

Q: What shift in understanding is required to stop Karma from being carried forward into a new life?

A: If only we realize we are not the body that dies and we are not the Mind and Ego, ME, then, Karma will not be carried forward. We will be free from Karma, if we realize we are not me but we are bound to the ground with lies and we believe that we are we will go into the skies, into a distant heaven. We still believe in the fairy tale. We believe that we will meet a God and on that day of judgement, we will be rewarded or punished. Why don't we realize that this body will return to dust?

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 14: How Is Karma Carried Forward?, Page 62

Q: How does the experience of Karma act as a reformatory tool to lead us toward freedom?

A: The Law of Karma teaches us that even good deeds are not enough. As long as we live as the body, mind and ego, we will inadvertently, have to suffer the pain of the body, misery of the mind and the agony of the ego. Therefore, the Law of Karma ultimately, reforms us and makes us realize the truth. It is Karma that reveals to us that our goal is to realize we are the Soul. It is the repeated Karma that we must face, life after life, that inspires us to be free from the cycle of death and rebirth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 17: Karma Is Not Punitive, It Is Reformatory, Page 73

Q: Why do most people fail to transcend the Law of Karma and achieve liberation?

A: For this, one needs Enlightenment, and this is not common. 99% of us just live, do our Karma and die. Based on our actions, good or bad, the Law of Karma will either reward us or punish us, respectively. Will you ever wonder why there are thorns growing in your garden? You wouldn't because you would know for sure that it was some seed that was planted. Why, then, do we wonder when bad things unfold in our life? Why do we presume that others are experiencing good luck? It is only because we have not understood the Law of Karma and how it works.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 3: How Does The Law Of Karma Work?, Page 18

Q: Using the analogy of a gun, how can we understand the concept of transcending the Karma of our physical actions?

A: To transcend Karma, we have to realize the truth that no doubt, the body does Karma but are we the body? No! If we believe that we are the body, then every action of ours is recorded as our Karma. Any action will have a reaction. The seed will bear fruit but what if we realize that we are not the body? Then, it is not our action. It is not our Karma. Let us think about any instrument of action. For instance, a gun. If we use a gun to shoot somebody, whose Karma is it? Is it the Karma of the gun that shot somebody dead or is it our Karma, the ones who used the gun to shoot? In this case, we will obviously say that the gun is just an instrument that has no life, so how can it be the Karma of the gun? But even if the gun had life, if it was not the gun that was responsible for the act, the Karma would belong to us and not the gun.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 27: Transcending Karma, Page 112

Q: Is it possible to be free from our opening balance of Karma (Prarabdha)?

A: Is there any way that we can be free from Prarabdha Karma? Yes, we can be free if only we realize that Karma doesn't belong to us and it is our ignorance that is causing us to return to earth in a rebirth with our Karma. Then, we can be liberated from our Prarabdha Karma and in fact, from all Karma and thereby, liberated from rebirth on earth. Moving forward, the goal of human life is to attain Liberation.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 7: Prarabdha Karma, Our Opening Balance, Page 33

TOPIC 7: MOKSHA & LIBERATION

Q: What is the ultimate goal of human life in relation to the Law of Karma?

A: Our goal of life is Moksha or Nirvana. What is this? It is to be free from Karma. Some people call it Salvation or Liberation. Our goal is to escape from this continuous cycle of death and rebirth and suffering on earth. Only man has been blessed with the faculty of intellect through which, he can be free from Karma and thus, being liberated, can be united with the Divine.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 15: Can We Be Free From Karma?, Page 64

Q: Are Moksha, Nirvana, and Salvation different concepts or do they share the same meaning?

A: What is Moksha? Is it the same as Nirvana or Salvation? Hindus believe that the goal of human existence is Moksha. The Buddhists believe that it is Nirvana, just as most of the Western world calls it Salvation. These are different names or terms but they have the same

meaning. They all refer to Liberation from the cycle of death and rebirth and Unification with God.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 19: Moksha, Liberation, Page 80

Q: What happens to a person who achieves liberation while still living in the physical body?

A: A person who attains Mukti is now free from all Karma. He is neither creating fresh Karma nor does have to redeem any past Karma. Such a person lives as a Jivanmutka, one who is liberated while alive. In the moment of death when the physical body dies and returns to dust, a Jivanmukta does not return to earth in a rebirth. A Jivanmutka has no Karma to settle. He attains Moksha. He is united with the Divine once he is liberated in the moment of the death of the physical body.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 18: Mukti, Freedom From Karma, Page 78

Q: How does the book describe the transition of the Soul during the moment of Moksha?

A: In the moment of death, the Soul, which originates from SIP, returns to SIP, as the body returns to dust. This is Moksha, Nirvana or Salvation. It is Liberation in the moment of death and Unification, becoming one with the Divine.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 19: Moksha, Liberation, Page 82

Q: How can a person perform actions without creating new Karma?

A: When we are enlightened with the truth and when there is the Realization that we are not the body, mind and ego, we attain Mukti. What does this mean? It means that we are free from all Karma. Even though we are performing actions, we are not creating any fresh Karma because we have realized that we are not the body, mind and ego. We live as a Divine instrument and thus, none of the Karma done by us is recorded in our Karmic account.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 18: Mukti, Freedom From Karma, Page 76

Q: Why is Enlightenment necessary to achieve Liberation from the Karmic cycle?

A: Enlightenment will lead us to a state of Mukti or Freedom, Moksha or Liberation. We need Enlightenment to overcome ignorance. Without Enlightenment, we will never be free from Karma. Without Enlightenment, we will believe in the lie, we will die and never discover, 'Who am 'I'?' We will live as the Body and the Mind and Ego, ME. We will try to do good deeds and create good Karma and this will only entangle us further in the Karmic cycle.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 20: Need Of Enlightenment, Page 85

Q: What prevents humans from attaining the state of SatChitAnanda and how can they achieve it?

A: Only man can be enlightened with the truth. Only we human beings can overcome ignorance. A butterfly or a bee may seem to have enough sense to exist as they fly and function but only man can realize, 'I am not the body, mind and ego. I am the Divine. I am a part of the Supreme Immortal Power, SIP.' Unfortunately, while we have been given the most profound gift of all, we remain prisoners of pleasures, possessions, people and do not attain the ultimate goal of Liberation and Unification.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 23: Liberation And Unification, Page 97

Q: Does performing good deeds alone lead to Moksha?

A: Many of us are caught in the myth that doing good Karma will lead to Moksha. As long as we do good Karma, thinking that we are the body, mind and ego, no doubt, we are creating good fortune in the future but we cannot attain Liberation or Moksha.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 15: Can We Be Free From Karma?, Page 66

Q: What happens to the accumulated Sanchita Karma when one attains Realization?

A: When we were born, our birth was because of our Prarabdha Karma. It was the opening balance that we started this life with, as the body, mind and ego. However, on realizing that we are not the body, mind and ego, even our Prarabdha Karma or opening balance is wiped out. If our Realization is not complete, we will continue to experience some of our Prarabdha Karma, we will continue to redeem some of our past deeds but a realized being does not suffer from such Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 18: Mukti, Freedom From Karma, Page 77

Q: How does a Karma Yogi view their actions in the context of liberation?

A: But the one who realizes the truth, the A to Z of Karma, becomes a Karma Yogi who lives as a Divine instrument. Only such an enlightened being is liberated from all suffering on earth. Such a realized Soul is not only free from Karma but attains the goal of realizing that he is a manifestation of the Divine.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 29: Life Is Karma, Page 121

Q: What analogy does the author use to explain the state of Unification with the Divine?

A: The purpose of our existence is to realize the truth that we are the Soul and reach the state of SatChitAnanda, that state of bliss that comes in truth Consciousness. It is in this state of joy that we will experience an ecstasy that knows no pain. We will be free from another birth on earth. We will become one with the Divine. The wave that was otherwise, splashing on the beach, again and again, will stop splashing as it becomes one with the ocean. This simple analogy is meant to explain Liberation and Unification.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 23: Liberation And Unification, Page 98

Q: What is the final outcome for a Karma Yogi at the moment of death?

A: In that ultimate moment when a Karma Yogi experiences death of the body, he is liberated from the cycle of rebirth. He does not return to earth. He attains Moksha, Nirvana or Salvation and becomes one with the Lord.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 28: Living As A Divine Instrument, Page 118

Q: Why must we go beyond even good deeds to attain Nirvana?

A: Our goal is to be free from all Karma. We must not imagine that doing good Karma will take us to heaven, where we will be rewarded. This is the biggest lie. Of course, we must do good deeds, for bad deeds will make us suffer but we must go beyond good deeds and beyond Karma, if we want Nirvana or Moksha. We must realize that Karma is an earthly law but we want to discover the heavenly truth, the truth that we are not the body, mind and ego that does the Karma. We are the Divine Soul.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 29: Life Is Karma, Page 121

Q: How does one transcend the pre-determined aspects of Karma to find freedom?

A: The truly wise ones realize that the goal is to transcend Karma. Whatever is happening, is happening as per our past Karma and therefore, we should accept without protest. Then, we must do our best, in terms of our present Karma. Having done our best, must we not surrender to Karma, the Divine law? Yes, we must but we can go one step further too. We can realize that we are the Divine Soul. Then realize that we have no Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 24: Is Everything Pre-determined?, Page 102

Q: What realization is required to start the process of Mukti?

A: We can attain that state of Mukti, being liberated from Karma through what we call as Realization. When we realize that Karma is performed by the body and we are not the body, so, we are not doing the Karma. Who is directing the body to act? It is the ME, the Mind and Ego. But we are neither the mind, nor the ego. The mind and ego are subtle in their existence. They seem to exist but in reality, they are an illusion.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 18: Mukti, Freedom From Karma, Page 76

TOPIC 8: ENLIGHTENMENT & THE GURU

Q: Why is a Spiritual Master or Guru essential for understanding and moving beyond Karma?

A: To understand the A to Z of Karma, it is very important to have a Spiritual Master, a Mentor or a Guru. A Guru is one who takes us from 'Gu' to 'Ru', that is, from darkness to light. As long as we try to understand Karma ourselves, we will use our mind. Our thoughts

will lead to confusion and therefore, there will be no conclusion. A Guru is the wise one. He is himself enlightened, has overcome ignorance and is a master of Karma. He can lead us from understanding Karma to finally, transcending it.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 21: Importance Of A Guru, Page 88

Q: Can a person change the deeds they have already committed in the past?

A: While we have a control on our present actions, do we have a control over our past deeds? No! Those deeds are already done and they have already been recorded by Karma. Not only have they caused our birth and our destiny till date but they will also continue to unfold as our Karma because these actions are done and cannot be reversed.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 11: Who Decided Your Birth?, Page 49

Q: What is the true definition and purpose of Enlightenment in the context of human life?

A: The word 'Enlightenment' means to bring in the light of Truth. Why should we bring in the light of truth? We should because we are enveloped in a blanket of ignorance. We live a life of darkness within ourselves. Although there is light in our outside world, there is darkness in our inner world and we cannot see the truth that is within. When we overcome this darkness within, when we eradicate our ignorance, it is called Enlightenment. Enlightenment is the Realization of the Truth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 20: Need Of Enlightenment, Page 84

Q: How does a Guru assist a seeker in reaching the state of Self-Realization?

A: My Guru helped me to go on a quest. He helped me seek the true purpose of life. It was because of my Guru that I evolved in my yearning for the Divine, for Eternal Happiness, for a purpose and reached the state of Self-Realization. I realized that I was not the body that was doing Karma. This body will perish. I was not the mind. My Guru used to joke with me. 'Let us find the mind,' he would say. There is no mind, yet, thoughts of the mind make us blind. With the guidance of my Master, I was able to let go of my ego, the false identity of 'me'.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 21: Importance Of A Guru, Page 90

Q: What are the consequences of living and dying without reaching a state of Enlightenment?

A: Enlightenment will lead us to a state of Mukti or Freedom, Moksha or Liberation. We need Enlightenment to overcome ignorance. Without Enlightenment, we will never be free from Karma. Without Enlightenment, we will believe in the lie, we will die and never discover, 'Who am I?' We will live as the Body and the Mind and Ego, ME. We will try to do good deeds and create good Karma and this will only entangle us further in the Karmic cycle. The body will die and we will return to earth in a rebirth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 20: Need Of Enlightenment, Page 85

Q: How can a human being achieve freedom from the actions performed by the body?

A: We can attain that state of Mukti, being liberated from Karma through what we call as Realization. When we realize that Karma is performed by the body and we are not the body, so, we are not doing the Karma. Who is directing the body to act? It is the ME, the Mind and Ego. But we are neither the mind, nor the ego. The mind and ego are subtle in their existence. They seem to exist but in reality, they are an illusion. They are a product of our ignorance. Because we do not realize that we are neither the body nor the mind and ego, we create Karma and suffer on earth, as well as, return in a rebirth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 18: Mukti, Freedom From Karma, Page 76

Q: What specific actions must a person take to begin the process of becoming enlightened?

A: To be enlightened with the truth, we have to 'Ask' and 'Investigate'. We have to unlearn what we have learnt. we have to wipe out the myth that we have grown with. Unless we clean the mug of our knowledge, we will never be able to pour the nectar of wisdom into the cup of our life. The information that we process is contaminated with lies. We can never be enlightened. We have to question everything. We cannot blindly believe what we are taught and we must not follow the herd too.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 20: Need Of Enlightenment, Page 86

Q: What happens to the Karmic account of a person who has attained the state of Mukti?

A: When we are enlightened with the truth and when there is the Realization that we are not the body, mind and ego, we attain Mukti. What does this mean? It means that we are free from all Karma. Even though we are performing actions, we are not creating any fresh Karma because we have realized that we are not the body, mind and ego. We live as a Divine instrument and thus, none of the Karma done by us is recorded in our Karmic account. In fact, we don't even have a Karmic account anymore because we have realized our true identity.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 18: Mukti, Freedom From Karma, Page 76

Q: Can a person navigate the complexities of the Law of Karma successfully without a Guru?

A: If one wants to understand the A to Z of Karma, one needs the guidance of a Guru, a Spiritual Master. A Guru is the wise one. Without the help of the Guru, we will remain in darkness, in ignorance and will suffer. Karma can be very confusing. What is this law? Who has created this law? How does it operate? What is the guarantee that the law exists to govern everything that is happening in the universe? If we cannot be free from action, then, how can we be free from Karma? Will we be caught in this cycle, forever?

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 21: Importance Of A Guru, Page 88

Q: What is the ultimate purpose of human existence and what state of being does it lead to?

A: The purpose of our existence is to realize the truth that we are the Soul and reach the state of SatChitAnanda, that state of bliss that comes in truth Consciousness. It is in this state of joy that we will experience an ecstasy that knows no pain. We will be free from another birth on earth. We will become one with the Divine. The wave that was otherwise, splashing on the beach, again and again, will stop splashing as it becomes one with the ocean.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 23: Liberation And Unification, Page 98

Q: Why is the belief that doing good Karma leads to God considered a form of ignorance?

A: What is the ignorance that causes maximum confusion in understanding Karma? Somehow, we believe that doing good Karma will lead us to God. This is our biggest ignorance. What makes us ignorant is our mind. Our mind continues to make us blind and we become ME, the Mind and Ego, that tries to do good Karma. The result is that we needlessly suffer. The cause is ignorance. We remain ignorant that we are this body, mind and ego. Therefore, we suffer the triple suffering on earth and return, again and again, in a rebirth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 16: Overcoming Ignorance And Suffering, Page 68

Q: What is the secret to acting in the world without creating new Karma?

A: To transcend Karma, we have to realize the truth that no doubt, the body does Karma but are we the body? No! If we believe that we are the body, then every action of ours is recorded as our Karma. Any action will have a reaction. The seed will bear fruit but what if we realize that we are not the body? Then, it is not our action. It is not our Karma. . . The moment we realize that we are just an instrument and not the doer of action, the moment we realize that we are just the Soul and not the body, then it is no more our action, it is no more our Karma and we will not have to face the corresponding reactions of the actions that we do.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 27: Transcending Karma, Page 112

Q: What characterizes the life and mindset of a true Karma Yogi?

A: A Karma Yogi has no desires. He transcends his passion and has only one obsession - to become one with the Divine. A Karma Yogi realizes, 'I am nothing'. I am not the body, mind and ego that I appear to be. I am a manifestation of SIP, the Supreme Immortal Power. Therefore, his life is not his anymore. He has surrendered his life completely to the Lord. Therefore, he has become an instrument of God, whose every action is as per his Divine mission, till the last moment of his life.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 28: *Living As A Divine Instrument*, Page 116

Q: How does the realization of being the Soul affect the process of death and rebirth?

A: If we realize that we are the Divine Soul, what happens in the moment of death? In the moment of death, if we have realized that we are not the body that dies, we are not the Mind and Ego, ME, we are the Divine Soul, then, there is no Karma. The Soul is energy and it does not create any Karma. This Realization liberates us from a future rebirth on earth. Therefore, the biggest challenge in our life or the purpose of our existence is to realize that we are the Divine Soul, we are a Spark Of Unique Life and not the body, mind and ego.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 22: *We Are A Divine Soul That Has No Karma*, Page 94

Q: What is the personal experience of the author after achieving spiritual enlightenment?

A: Realization of the truth about Karma was one of the major aspects of my Spiritual Enlightenment. Thereafter, I have lived as a Karma Yogi, a Divine instrument to become one with SIP. Today, I live in a state of Eternal Bliss and peace, the state of SatChitAnanda, just as I continue on my life mission to help people transcend their Karma and be free from all suffering on earth and rebirth.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 29: *Life Is Karma (Afterword)*, Page 137

TOPIC 9: DESTINY & LIVING AS A DIVINE INSTRUMENT

Q: If our life is dictated by past actions, does that mean we have no choice in how we live today?

A: Suppose, you are driving a car. The car is in your control and you can go fast or slow, turn left or right, go ahead or reverse. This is your free will or your present Karma. This is not your Prarabdha Karma or the opening balance. However, you can't change the road. The road is already laid. This is like your past Karma, which cannot be changed. The road ahead is because of the Prarabdha Karma, the opening balance which is nothing but our past Karma unfolding in our life.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 7: *Prarabdha Karma, Our Opening Balance*, Page 34

Q: If everything is predestined, how can a person still be held responsible for their actions?

A: While there is no doubt that Karma creates some amount of a predestined life, it does not deprive us of the opportunity to choose our actions and create fresh Karma. Our past actions determine several aspects of our predestined present life. Our gender, date of birth, place of birth and parents are some aspects of our predestined life that our past Karmas create. However, our actions are not predestined. Only our circumstances are. Whatever is happening around us is predestined due to our past Karma, but what action we take

depends on our own choice, our own free will and thereafter, we are responsible for our present actions and our destiny.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 1: FAQ ON KARMA, Page 123

Q: Does the Law of Karma mean that we are just biological robots following a script?

A: If everything was pre-determined, then, we would be robots and not human beings. A human being has been given the power of discrimination. Man has the privilege to choose his actions. No other creature has the power of the will. A dog cannot decide what it will eat for dinner. Would we feel good to live like a dog or a frog in the well? No! All these creatures suffer and it seems that suffering is an outcome of Karma. Why else would a worm be smashed with a shoe? It is all Karma. It is all part of the Divine drama. We sometimes look at it as cruel but it is just a part of the Divine plan, which we have to accept and not question.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 24: Is Everything Pre-determined?, Page 100

Q: How does the author illustrate the difference between past karma and current free will using a vehicle analogy?

A: Imagine that you are riding a bike. Do you have complete control on your journey? You may have complete control on the bike but what about the road? The road is already paved. You cannot change the road. The road is your Prarabdha Karma. It is your opening balance but you can go fast or slow, left or right and even do stunts on your bike and go reverse, if you don't want to go forward. While you have complete control on your car, can you stop an accident from happening when a truck crashes into you? You did nothing wrong but still, a truck that had a brake failure, threw your bike off the road. Why did this happen? Obviously, it is your past Karma. You had committed some wrong in the past equivalent to this crash. Now, it is redeemed.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 25: Twin Karma Controls Our Destiny, Page 104

Q: What is the ultimate strategy for a wise person dealing with the unfolding of destiny?

A: The truly wise ones realize that the goal is to transcend Karma. Whatever is happening, is happening as per our past Karma and therefore, we should accept without protest. Then, we must do our best, in terms of our present Karma. Having done our best, must we not surrender to Karma, the Divine law? Yes, we must but we can go one step further too. We can realize that we are the Divine Soul. Then realize that we have no Karma. We are not the body that experiences Karma. We are not the Mind and Ego, ME, that carries forward Karma to the next life.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 24: Is Everything Pre-determined?, Page 102

Q: If action is unavoidable for the body, how can a human reach a state of freedom from the law of action and reaction?

A: We can attain that state of Mukti, being liberated from Karma through what we call as Realization. When we realize that Karma is performed by the body and we are not the body, so, we are not doing the Karma. Who is directing the body to act? It is the ME, the Mind and Ego. But we are neither the mind, nor the ego. The mind and ego are subtle in their existence. They seem to exist but in reality, they are an illusion. They are a product of our ignorance. Because we do not realize that we are neither the body nor the mind and ego, we create Karma and suffer on earth, as well as, return in a rebirth.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 18: Mukti, Freedom From Karma, Page 76

Q: What happens to our karmic record when we start living as a 'Divine instrument'?

A: When we are enlightened with the truth and when there is the Realization that we are not the body, mind and ego, we attain Mukti. What does this mean? It means that we are free from all Karma. Even though we are performing actions, we are not creating any fresh Karma because we have realized that we are not the body, mind and ego. We live as a Divine instrument and thus, none of the Karma done by us is recorded in our Karmic account. In fact, we don't even have a Karmic account anymore because we have realized our true identity.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 18: Mukti, Freedom From Karma, Page 77

Q: Is the goal of life simply to collect as much good karma as possible through virtuous deeds?

A: Doing good Karma is the right thing but ultimately, there is something better than just doing good Karma. It is transcending Karma. It is realizing that Karma doesn't belong to me. It is overcoming ignorance and being free from both, Karma and rebirth. This is our ultimate goal.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 15: Can We Be Free From Karma?, Page 66

Q: What does it mean to be a 'Karma Yogi' and how does it change the nature of one's actions?

A: If one has understood the A to Z of Karma, then he transcends Karma, goes beyond the Law of Action and Reaction and lives as a Divine instrument of the Lord. One does not seek any rewards for their Karma, although they do good deeds. They realize that they are the Divine Soul and not the body, mind and ego that they appear to be. Being enlightened with the truth, they become a Karma Yogi, one who is ever-united with the Divine, doing Karma as an offering to the Lord. When one seeks no fruits for the seeds that they are planting, their deeds are no more Karma. Their actions become Karma Yoga.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 28: *Living As A Divine Instrument*, Page 116

Q: Does a Karma Yogi still have to face the opening balance of karma they were born with?

A: Is a Karma Yogi free from all Karma? Yes, he is free from all his Karma and no more creates any fresh Karma because although he is living in a body, mind and ego complex, he is no more the Karta or the doer of an action. Therefore, his current account of Karma or Agami Karma is closed. He creates no new Karma, whatsoever. What about his Prarabdha Karma or the opening balance of Karma that he started with? A truly enlightened Karma Yogi is even free from Prarabdha Karma too. Although he is living in the body and it may appear that the body is receiving the Karma or the reaction of past action, the Karma Yogi is unaffected by this.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 28: *Living As A Divine Instrument*, Page 117

Q: Can you provide an example of an enlightened master who lived as a Divine instrument while facing physical illness?

A: We are told of Sri Ramakrishna Paramahansa, Guru of Swami Vivekananda. He was an enlightened one and lived as a Divine instrument, a Karma Yogi. However, his body was inflicted with cancer and he would get spasms of pain. He would laugh intermittently, expressing how the body was being attacked but suffered no pain. It is not easy to live like Sri Ramakrishna Paramahansa, a real Karma Yogi. He had realized God and not only saw God in his disciple, Swami Vivekananda but could see God in every living creature, in every being. He gave up his life, realizing that he was nothing but a Divine instrument.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 28: *Living As A Divine Instrument*, Page 117

Q: What is required for an ordinary person to transition into living as a Divine instrument?

A: Can we all be Karma Yogis? Yes, we can. Becoming a Karma Yogi or a Divine instrument must reflect in our life and our actions. We cannot just say that we are a Karma Yogi. We have to realize that we are nothing but the Soul, a particle of SIP, the Supreme. Having realized this, every action of ours must be driven by the Divine Will. Only when we hand over the control of our life to the Supreme and every act of ours is directed by the Lord, we will be completely free from Karma and this drama.

Source: *The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition)*, Chapter 28: *Living As A Divine Instrument*, Page 118

Q: How does the author use the example of a gun to explain the transcendence of action?

A: To transcend Karma, we have to realize the truth that no doubt, the body does Karma but are we the body? No! If we believe that we are the body, then every action of ours is recorded as our Karma. Any action will have a reaction. The seed will bear fruit but what if we realize that we are not the body? Then, it is not our action. It is not our Karma. Let us think about any instrument of action. For instance, a gun. If we use a gun to shoot somebody, whose Karma is it? Is it the Karma of the gun that shot somebody dead or is it our Karma, the ones who used the gun to shoot? In this case, we will obviously say that the gun is just an instrument that has no life, so how can it be the Karma of the gun? But even if the gun had life, if it was not the gun that was responsible for the act, the Karma would belong to us and not the gun.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 27: Transcending Karma, Page 112

Q: Who is the actual 'owner' and carrier of karma throughout multiple lifetimes?

A: The ME, the Mind and Ego, is the one that owns the Karma. The body will die but the Mind and Ego, ME, carries Karma, birth after birth, as it returns to earth. So, are we the mind and ego? If only we realize that we are not the mind, it is something that we cannot find, it is just a bundle of thoughts and further, if we realize that we are not the ego that keeps saying 'I', 'me' and 'mine', this ego is a false identity, then, we transcend ME, that owns Karma and we go beyond the three accounts of Karma. For this, we have to realize we are the Divine Soul and the Soul has no Karma.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 27: Transcending Karma, Page 113

Q: What governs our daily destiny if it isn't purely pre-determined?

A: Everything happening in the journey of life is because of twin Karma. It is a combination of our past and present actions. It depends on our past actions, over which we have no control, and our present actions, over which we have complete control. Therefore, it is both, our past and present actions that become the twin karma that determine the destiny of our life.

Source: The A to Z of Karma (2nd Edition), Chapter 25: Twin Karma Controls Our Destiny, Page 105